



Team InfoAxon

'Platforming': A Unique Formula for Lasting Business Partnerships

Noida headquartered InfoAxon Technologies erases all doubts around the profitability of an open source business. It uses the 'platforming' approach to cement long lasting relationships with its customers.

*I*nfoAxon Technologies began business focusing on proprietary technology back in 2001. But it soon took the plunge into the open source world within a year.

InfoAxon has grown steadily from Rs 20 million in 2003 to Rs 50 million in 2009, and is expected to clock revenues of Rs 100 million this fiscal. Along the way, it has grown from a four-member team to an 80-strong army, comprising open source architects, platform designers, open source evangelists and open source developers. Armed with open source, it has won over customers in the UK, South Africa and India.

The story of InfoAxon Technologies speaks volumes for the profitability of an open source business. "It is true that initially most businesses jumping onto the open source bandwagon didn't

have a profitable business model. However, that was not because you couldn't have one, but because most of those selling open source and benefiting from it got fixated to the 'free' aspect of open source. They discounted the crucial values of open source technology like choice, flexibility and innovation. Thus, they soon hit a dead end on the business road. For companies like ours, which saw open source technology as a development model and participated in and augmented the collaborative work of the community, the business model automatically happened alongside," says Shubham Nagar, chief executive officer, InfoAxon Technologies.

The open road

Four friends, with a mix of technical, financial and marketing skills, set up InfoAxon Technologies in 2001. Post the dot com bust,